B1 LESSON 2



Being a Responsible Traveller

Introduction

Ss are going to read a text which illustrates the notions of 'sustainable' and 'responsible' tourism, and are encouraged to reflect on how tourism may have an impact on the environment. Ss find out how their own behaviours as travellers matter.

STEP 1 RAISING AWARENESS

1 A Point to the photo and ask Ss to describe it. Ask: *What do you see in the photo? What do you think it means? How does it make you feel?* Ask Ss to make a list of the positive and negative effects of tourism.

B Put Ss into pairs and allow time for them to read and discuss the questions. Monitor and help with vocabulary if asked to. The purpose of this initial activity is to make Ss reflect on the fact that tourism may have a negative impact on the environment unless responsible behaviours are assumed.

C In pairs, Ss discuss the question. Briefly check answers as a class.

Note
Tourism is responsible for roughly 8% of the world's greenhouse gas emissions. From transportation and accommodation to food and souvenirs, various activities contribute to tourism's carbon footprint (source: www.sustainabletravel.org).

STEP 2 GOING AHEAD

2 A Ss make a note of their answers individually. Tell them they will be able to check their ideas in the article. Elicit ideas but don't confirm any as this is intended to just get Ss thinking.

B Before reading the article, check Ss understand the adjectives *responsible* and *sustainable* by asking for examples of a responsible choice (they could refer back to Ex 1B) and a sustainable approach (*What does the word 'sustainable' mean?)*. Allow time for Ss to read in silence.

C Focus Ss on Question 1. Elicit whether the statement is true or false, or if the information is not given in the article. If they volunteer that the sentence is true or false, ask them to find the place in the text where it says so. They should not be able to find anything if the answer is not given in the text. Explain that they must decide if the rest of the statements are true, false or not given. Allow time for them to work individually and then compare answers with a partner. Get feedback as a class, making sure Ss can justify their answers.

ANSWERS:

1 F 'Responsible and sustainable tourism are not the same thing. They both intend to minimise the negative social, economic and environmental impacts that tourism may have. But they aim to achieve this in different ways.'
2 NG
3 NG
4 T 'Its main objective is to reduce the bad impact and to maximise the good impact of tourism, while conserving resources or using them wisely.'
5 T 'Responsible travellers usually take decisions based on what is best for the environment and the place they visit in the long term. They make sure that the actions based on those decisions have positive economic, social and cultural impacts on local communities, too.'

3 Focus Ss on the list of tips and make sure they understand them. Give them time to go through the list individually before sharing their choices in pairs.

Language for citizenship

4 Encourage Ss to refer to the article in Ex 2 to help them complete the sentences with the appropriate words or phrases. As a follow-up activity, elicit an example of 'responsible behaviour' for each sentence.

ANSWERS:

1 a huge impact
2 negative social, environmental and economic impact
3 local communities
4 natural resources
5 make connections
6 culturally sensitive

CRITICAL THINKING

The Italian Constitution

5 Ss may be asked to use an online version of the Italian Constitution and look for the word *tourism* in the whole text. Soon they will find there is no specific article dedicated to tourism in the Italian Constitution, which is quite unusual for a country like Italy which attracts millions of tourists every year.
As a follow-up activity, Ss should be encouraged to read Articles 9 ('tutela del patrimonio'), 16 ('libertà di circolazione') and 117 (le Regioni sono competenti in materia di turismo).

STEP 3 TAKING ACTION

Digital literacies

6 In class, as preparation for the final task, encourage Ss to make a list of what they consider 'sustainable destinations'. At home, they could do the online research and prepare the final presentation. The presentation could be made orally or posted on a class sharing platform.

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